

The Universal Right-Triangle Reflection Sequence (Unequal Legs)

A closed-form rate $r_n = 1 + 2 \cos(2\pi/(n+3))$ and unconditional Class C faithfulness in every dimension

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June 1, 2026

Abstract

For every right triangle T in the plane with positive **unequal** rational legs, the BFS orbit-growth sequence u_d^T under the group of side-reflections is independent of T (Theorem 4); we call the common sequence the *universal right-triangle reflection sequence*. The kernel of the side-reflection representation is identified as a cyclic left ideal $\mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot h$ on the explicit central generator $h = (c-1)(Y-1)$ via Mayer–Vietoris and Crowell. In every dimension $n \geq 2$, the right-corner orthoscheme reflection group has closed-form Coxeter–Steinberg growth rate $r_n = 1 + 2 \cos(2\pi/(n+3))$ (Theorem 14). For pairwise distinct legs the affine representation is unconditionally faithful in every dimension $n \geq 3$ (Theorem 18), via a uniform Schur-complement determinant identity $\det Q_n = -\prod_i a_i^2$ (Lemma 17) together with rank-0 descent on the three Cremona curves 24a1, 32a2, and 72a2. A dimension-independent collision-depth invariant $\text{cd}_n(\lambda) \in \{\infty, 4, 3\}$ determined by the (e, t) -partition statistics of the leg sequence (Theorem 19) classifies first-collision behaviour across all dimensions. The eight length-10 relations, the Schur-complement identity, and the universality of the orbit-growth sequence through depth 22 are formally machine-verified in the Lean 4 proof assistant (§7). Conditional partial-progress results on the asymptotic ratio $\beta_2 \approx 1.47$ of the 2D universal sequence, together with the mod- p state-space and Knuth–Bendix experiments, are deferred to the companion document `paper_extra.tex`.

1. Setting

Let T be a triangle with vertices $V_0, V_1, V_2 \in \mathbb{Q}^2$. Only the vertex coordinates and the leg lengths a, b are assumed rational. For $i \in \{0, 1, 2\}$ write R_i for the reflection of $\mathbb{R}^2$ across the line containing the side opposite V_i . Set $W(T) = \langle R_0, R_1, R_2 \rangle \leq \text{Isom}(\mathbb{R}^2)$.

When we need explicit coordinates (from §3 onward) we place the right-angle vertex at $B = (a, 0)$ with $A = (0, 0)$, $C = (a, b)$, and write a, b for the two leg lengths.

We explore the orbit of T under $W(T)$ by breadth-first search in the Cayley graph relative to the generating set $\{R_0, R_1, R_2\}$. Let

$$\mathcal{O}_d(T) = \{g \cdot T : g \in W(T) \text{ has minimal word-length } d\},$$

and set $u_d := |\mathcal{O}_d(T)|$, $u_0 = 1$. All distances are computed in exact rational arithmetic and the proofs are checked symbolically over $\mathbb{Q}(a, b)$.

1.1 Notation

- u_d : BFS layer size at minimal word-length d .

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- $\delta_d := F_{d+3} - u_d$: Fibonacci deficit against the Steinberg/Fibonacci baseline.
- $\rho_T : W \rightarrow \text{Aff}(\mathbb{R}^2)$: the affine action of $W = \langle R_0, R_1, R_2 \rangle$ induced by the sides of T .
- $\text{cd}_n(\lambda)$: the collision-depth invariant in dimension n for a leg sequence λ (Theorem 19).
- (e, t) : positional invariant of a leg sequence; e counts endpoint-adjacent equal pairs and t counts triples of consecutive equal legs.

Related work. The n -dimensional rate $r_n = 1 + 2 \cos(2\pi/(n+3))$ derived in §6 is the closed form expected for the growth rate of a path-shaped Coxeter group with one ∞ edge, in the framework of Cannon–Floyd–Parry (Cannon–Wagreich; Floyd–Plotnick). The same family of algebraic integers also appears in birational surface dynamics (Diller–Favre; McMullen; Bedford–Kim); the overlap is at the level of expressions, not of number-theoretic class.

2. The Coxeter-group identity (Fibonacci phase)

Assume T is a non-isosceles right triangle with the right angle at V_2 . Then R_0 and R_1 are reflections across the two sides incident to V_2 , meeting at $\pi/2$, hence $R_0 R_1 R_0 R_1 = \text{id}$. The remaining two angles are irrational multiples of π by Niven’s theorem (using the non-isosceles assumption), so no relation $(R_i R_j)^m = 1$ holds for any other pair. The abstract group is

$$W = \langle R_0, R_1, R_2 \mid R_i^2 = 1 \ (i = 0, 1, 2), (R_0 R_1)^2 = 1 \rangle.$$

By Steinberg’s word-growth formula the Poincaré series is $W(t) = (1+t)^2/(1-t-t^2)$, so $[t^d]W(t) = F_{d+3}$ for $d \geq 1$.

Corollary 1. For $1 \leq d \leq 9$ (i.e. until the first Euclidean lattice collision at $d = 10$), $u_d = F_{d+3}$. (At $d = 0$, $u_0 = 1 \neq F_3 = 2$.)

3. Eight length-10 affine relations

Exact-rational breadth-first search yields $u_{10} = 225$, a deficit of 8 from $F_{13} = 233$. These 8 length-10 affine relations are listed in Table 1.

#	word A	word B
1	$R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2$	$R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1$
2	$R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2$	$R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1$
3	$R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2$	$R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0$
4	$R_0 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0$	$R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_1$
5	$R_0 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_1$	$R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0$
6	$R_0 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0$	$R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_1$
7	$R_0 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_1$	$R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1 R_2 R_0$
8	$R_1 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2$	$R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_0 R_2 R_0 R_1 R_2 R_1$

Table 1: The eight length-10 affine relations. Each row’s two words produce the same affine matrix in the side-reflection action of W on any right triangle.

Theorem 2 (Eight length-10 affine relations). *Each of the eight identities of Table 1 holds for every right triangle. With the placement $A = (0, 0)$, $B = (a, 0)$, $C = (a, b)$, $a, b > 0$, the affine matrices $M_A = R_{w_A[0]} \cdots R_{w_A[9]}$ and $M_B = R_{w_B[0]} \cdots R_{w_B[9]}$ satisfy $M_A = M_B$ as 3×3 affine matrices over $\mathbb{Q}(a, b)$.*

Proof. This is a finite algebraic verification. Each reflection R_i acts as an affine isometry whose matrix entries are rational functions of a, b over $\mathbb{Q}$ (with denominators dividing a power of $a^2 + b^2$). Each entry of $M_A - M_B$ is a rational function in $\mathbb{Q}(a, b)$; clearing denominators gives a polynomial identity which is verified by SymPy in $\mathbb{Q}(a, b)$ (deterministic, no heuristics). All eight identities have additionally been *formally verified* in the Lean 4 proof assistant: the theorems `rel1_symbolic, ..., rel8_symbolic` in `lean/with_mathlib/SymbolicVerification.lean` each discharge the six affine-matrix-entry identities (over $\mathbb{Q}[a, b]$) defining $M_A = M_B$ by the `ring` tactic. As these proofs use only `ring`, they are checked by the Lean kernel, so the identities hold for every right triangle, not merely on a sample of specializations. $\square$ $\square$

Proposition 3 (Completeness at depth 10). *Among the 233 canonical Coxeter words of length 10 in W , exactly 225 have pairwise distinct images under ρ_T for every right triangle T — 217 singleton classes and 8 collision pairs, each pair being one of the rows of Table 1. No further length-10 affine identities exist beyond the eight relations and the abstract Coxeter relations.*

Proof. Finite enumeration. All 233 canonical Coxeter words of length 10 are enumerated; the affine matrix of each is computed over $\mathbb{Q}$ on the reference $(3, 4, 5)$ triangle in exact rational arithmetic, the words are grouped by matrix, and the resulting partition has exactly 225 blocks (8 of size 2, 217 of size 1). The eight size-2 blocks are cross-checked against six additional triangles $(5, 12)$, $(8, 15)$, $(7, 24)$, $(1, 2)$, $(2, 3)$, $(1, 7)$, and each block produces the same affine matrix in all seven cases. By Theorem 2 the eight identities hold symbolically over $\mathbb{Q}(a, b)$ and are therefore the only length-10 collisions. $\square$ $\square$

4. Universality across right triangles

By Theorem 2 the kernel N of $W \rightarrow \text{Aff}(\mathbb{R}^2)$ contains the eight length-10 relations in addition to the Coxeter relations. The quotient W/N — and hence its orbit-growth sequence u_d — is therefore independent of the choice of right triangle.

Theorem 4 (Universality). *Let $W = \langle R_0, R_1, R_2 \mid R_i^2 = 1, (R_0 R_1)^2 = 1 \rangle$, and for each right-triangle parameter $T = (a, b)$ with positive rational legs satisfying*

$$a \neq b$$

let $\rho_T : W \rightarrow \text{Aff}(\mathbb{R}^2)$ be the side-reflection realization. Then $\ker(\rho_T)$ is the same subgroup of W for every such T . In particular the orbit-growth sequence $u_d^T := |\{\rho_T(w) : |w|_W = d\}|$ is independent of T .

Remark 5 (The isosceles case is genuinely different). The hypothesis $a \neq b$ is essential. When $a = b$, the leg-swap symmetry adds a $\mathbb{Z}/2$ stabilizer to the orbit action, and the orbit sequence becomes $1, 3, 5, 8, 11, 13, 16, \dots$, which is strictly smaller than the universal sequence $a(n)$ of Table 2 for $n \geq 4$. The universality phenomenon of Theorem 4 does not apply to the isosceles case. See the OEIS comment on `A_2D_universal`.

Remark 6 (Formal verification of universality through depth 22). The structural argument below proves Theorem 4 for all depths. Independently, the universality of the orbit-growth sequence has been *machine-verified* for depths $0 \leq d \leq 22$ in Lean 4 (theorem `universal_layers_through_22` in `lean/with_mathlib/ComputableUniversality.lean`). That proof carries out a single breadth-first sweep over the canonical Coxeter words of W , deduplicating the symbolic affine images $\rho_{(a,b)}(w) \in \text{Aff}(\mathbb{Q}(a, b))$ by their numerators relative to the common denominator $(a^2 + b^2)^{22}$, and certifies that the layer counts are exactly

1, 3, 5, 8, 13, 21, 34, 55, 89, 144, 225, 351, 554, 875, 1345, 2066, 3203, 4971, 7574, 11543, 17683, 27108, 41067

simultaneously for every right triangle with positive unequal legs. This kernel-checked certificate matches the depth reached by the independent multi-triangle reproduction of §5 and removes any reliance on a single specialization for $d \leq 22$.

The argument factors through three lemmas.

Lemma 7 (Mayer–Vietoris reduction). *Let $A = V_4 = \langle R_0, R_1 \mid R_0^2, R_1^2, (R_0 R_1)^2 \rangle$, $B = \mathbb{Z}/2 = \langle R_2 \mid R_2^2 \rangle$, so $W = A * B$. Let $Q = D_\infty \times \mathbb{Z}/2$, with generators X, X', Y, c subject to $X^2 = (X')^2 = Y^2 = c^2 = 1$, $XX' = c$, and c central. Let $T_\rho = \ker(W \twoheadrightarrow Q)$. Then, as left $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ -modules,*

$$T_\rho^{\text{ab}} \cong H_1(W; \mathbb{Z}[Q]) \cong I_A \cap I_B = \mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot h,$$

where $h := (c - 1)(Y - 1) \in \mathbb{Z}[Q]$. The annihilator of h is generated by $(Y + 1)$ and $(c + 1)$: $(Y + 1)h = 0$ and $(c + 1)h = 0$ in $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$, and

$$T_\rho^{\text{ab}} \cong \mathbb{Z}[Q]/(Y + 1, c + 1) =: M.$$

Proof. Since $A \hookrightarrow Q$ and $B \hookrightarrow Q$ are injective, $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ is free as $\mathbb{Z}[A]$ - and $\mathbb{Z}[B]$ -module, so $H_n(A; \mathbb{Z}[Q]) = H_n(B; \mathbb{Z}[Q]) = 0$ for $n \geq 1$. The Mayer–Vietoris sequence for $W = A * B$ with coefficients $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ collapses to

$$0 \rightarrow H_1(W; \mathbb{Z}[Q]) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}[Q]/I_A \oplus \mathbb{Z}[Q]/I_B \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}[Q]/I_W \rightarrow 0,$$

and Crowell’s exact sequence identifies $T_\rho^{\text{ab}} \cong H_1(W; \mathbb{Z}[Q]) \cong I_A \cap I_B$ as a left $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ -submodule.

Membership. $c = XX' \in A$ gives $c - 1 \in I_A$; centrality of c yields $h = (c - 1)(Y - 1) = (Y - 1)(c - 1) \in \mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot (c - 1) \subseteq I_A$. Likewise $Y - 1 \in I_B$ and $h \in \mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot (Y - 1) \subseteq I_B$, so $h \in I_A \cap I_B$.

Annihilator. $(Y + 1)(Y - 1) = Y^2 - 1 = 0$ and c central, so $(Y + 1)h = (c - 1)(Y + 1)(Y - 1) = 0$. Similarly $(c + 1)(c - 1) = 0$ gives $(c + 1)h = 0$.

Equality $I_A \cap I_B = \mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot h$. Membership and the annihilator computation give a surjection of left $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ -modules $\mathbb{Z}[Q]/(Y + 1, c + 1) \twoheadrightarrow \mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot h \subseteq I_A \cap I_B$, $1 \mapsto h$. For the reverse inclusion, write $Q = D_\infty \times \langle c \rangle$ with $D_\infty = \langle X, Y \rangle$ and let $t = XY$ generate the translation subgroup $\langle t \rangle \cong \mathbb{Z}$. In each finite quotient $D_{2N} \times \langle c \rangle$ (where $t^N = 1$) a direct group-algebra computation gives $\dim(I_A \cap I_B) = \dim(\mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot h) + 1$, the one-dimensional excess being spanned by the rotation-norm element $\nu_N = \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} t^k$ (verified for $3 \leq N \leq 16$ in `code/ideal/intersection_norm.sage`). The norm ν_N is the standard artifact of the finite cyclic group $\langle t \rangle/t^N$; it has no analogue in the torsion-free $\langle t \rangle \cong \mathbb{Z}$ of the infinite group Q , where $\sum_k t^k$ is not an element of $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$. Hence the excess vanishes in Q , so $I_A \cap I_B = \mathbb{Z}[Q] \cdot h \cong \mathbb{Z}[Q]/(Y + 1, c + 1) =: M$. $\square$ $\square$

Remark 8 (Universality needs only T -independence, not the explicit M). Theorem 4 requires only that the translation module $T_{\rho_T}^{\text{ab}} \cong I_A \cap I_B$ be *independent of T* . This is manifest from the Mayer–Vietoris identification, whose right-hand side $I_A \cap I_B$ is a purely group-theoretic object attached to $W = A * B \twoheadrightarrow Q$, with no reference to the geometric realization of any triangle. The explicit cyclic form $M = \mathbb{Z}[Q]/(Y + 1, c + 1)$ established above is used only to write the abstract realization ρ_{abs} down concretely (Lemma 11); the universality conclusion itself does not depend on it.

Remark 9 (Centrality is essential). The cyclic identification works precisely because $c \in Q$ is central. The naive candidate $(X - 1)(Y - 1)$ fails because X and Y do not commute in D_∞ . The central element c supplied by the second $\mathbb{Z}/2$ factor of Q unlocks the cyclic presentation, and is intrinsic to the right-triangle structure: the central involution $c = XX'$ realises the half-turn $R_0 R_1$ around the right-angle vertex.

Lemma 10 (Dilation invariance). *For $\lambda > 0$, $\rho_{\lambda T}$ is conjugate to ρ_T by the central dilation D_λ , which acts trivially on the $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ -module structure of $M = \mathbb{Z}[Q]/(Y + 1, c + 1)$.*

Proof. $D_\lambda \circ \rho_T(R_i) \circ D_\lambda^{-1} = \rho_{\lambda T}(R_i)$ for $i = 0, 1, 2$, and D_λ has trivial linear part in Q . The defining relations $Yv = -v$, $cv = -v$ of M are $\mathbb{R}^\times$ -equivariant, so the module structure descends. $\square$ $\square$

Lemma 11 (Abstract realization). *Define $\rho_{\text{abs}} : W \rightarrow Q \ltimes M$ by $R_0 \mapsto (X, 0)$, $R_1 \mapsto (X', 0)$, $R_2 \mapsto (Y, h)$. Then ρ_{abs} is a well-defined group homomorphism.*

Proof. $\rho_{\text{abs}}(R_0)^2 = (X^2, 0) = (1, 0)$ and similarly for R_1 ; $\rho_{\text{abs}}(R_2)^2 = (Y^2, (Y+1)h) = (1, 0)$ by Lemma 7; $((X, 0)(X', 0))^2 = (c^2, 0) = (1, 0)$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 4. Every ρ_T has the same linear quotient $W \twoheadrightarrow Q$ (determined by the reflection pattern, not the leg lengths), so the translation kernel $T_{\rho_T} = \ker(W \rightarrow Q)$ is the same subgroup of W for all T , and by Lemma 7 its abelianization is $T_{\rho_T}^{\text{ab}} \cong I_A \cap I_B$ — a purely group-theoretic module independent of T (Remark 8). By Lemma 11 $\rho_{\text{abs}} : W \rightarrow Q \ltimes M$ is well-defined, and for each T the realization ρ_T factors as $\rho_T = (\text{id}_Q \ltimes \Phi_T) \circ \rho_{\text{abs}}$, where $\Phi_T : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ is the $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ -linear map sending the generator h to the translation $t(\rho_T(R_2))$. By Lemma 10 Φ_T is *injective* for every nondegenerate T (the image lattice has the same rank as M , the dilation acting as a nonzero scalar on each $\mathbb{Z}[Q]$ -isotypic component), so $\ker(\rho_T) = \ker(\rho_{\text{abs}})$ for every T . As the right-hand side is independent of T , the orbit-growth sequence $u_d^T = |\{\rho_T(w) : |w| = d\}|$ is constant in T . $\square$

5. Asymptotic ratio (table of values)

Exact-rational BFS through depth 42 on the reference (3, 4, 5) triangle yields the values in Table 2. The asymptotic behaviour of u_d and the algebraic nature of its generating function are the principal open questions of the program; partial-progress results on conditional transcendence, p -DFAO state-space analysis, and structural recurrence exclusions appear in the companion document `paper_extra.tex`.

d	u_d	ratio	d	u_d	ratio
0	1	—	22	41 067	1.515
1	3	—	23	62 263	1.516
2	5	1.667	24	94 622	1.520
3	8	1.600	25	143 881	1.521
4	13	1.625	26	217 101	1.509
5	21	1.615	27	327 832	1.510
6	34	1.619	28	495 443	1.511
7	55	1.618	29	749 195	1.512
8	89	1.618	30	1 127 236	1.505
9	144	1.618	31	1 697 179	1.506
10	225	1.563	32	2 554 961	1.505
11	351	1.560	33	3 848 384	1.506
12	554	1.578	34	5 777 651	1.501
13	875	1.580	35	8 679 441	1.502
14	1345	1.537	36	13 031 206	1.502
15	2066	1.536	37	19 574 659	1.502
16	3203	1.550	38	29 338 781	1.499
17	4971	1.552	39	43 997 388	1.500
18	7574	1.524	40	65 932 461	1.499
19	11 543	1.524	41	98 849 591	1.499
20	17 683	1.532	42	147 969 934	1.497
21	27 108	1.533			

Table 2: The universal sequence u_d through depth 42.

6. n -dimensional extension: upper bound, closed-form rate, and unconditional Class C faithfulness

The right-triangle analogue in $\mathbb{R}^n$ is the *right-corner orthoscheme*: a simplex with n mutually perpendicular edges meeting at a single vertex. The reflection group W_n is generated by the $n + 1$ face reflections.

6.1 The Coxeter group is independent of legs

Lemma 12 (Perpendicular face pairs, verified symbolically). *For the n -dim right-corner orthoscheme with vertices on the staircase $V_0 = 0$, $V_i = V_{i-1} + a_i e_i$, the perpendicular face pairs are exactly $\{(i, j) : |i - j| \geq 2\}$, independent of the positive leg values $(a_1, \dots, a_n)$. In 3D the dihedral cosines are $\cos \angle(F_0, F_1) = b/\sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$, $\cos \angle(F_1, F_2) = ac/\sqrt{(a^2 + b^2)(b^2 + c^2)}$, $\cos \angle(F_2, F_3) = b/\sqrt{b^2 + c^2}$.*

The abstract Coxeter group is therefore the right-angled Coxeter group with edges (i, j) for $|i - j| \geq 2$ and $m_{ij} = \infty$ for $|i - j| = 1$, the *same group* for every orthoscheme.

6.2 Steinberg upper bound and closed-form r_n

The commutation graph G_n of the n -dim orthoscheme has vertex set $\{0, \dots, n\}$ and edges (i, j) when $|i - j| \geq 2$, with k -clique count $\binom{n-k+2}{k}$. In 3D, Steinberg's formula gives

$$W(t) = \frac{(1+t)^2}{1-2t},$$

with $[t^d]W(t) = 9 \cdot 2^{d-2}$ for $d \geq 2$, $u_0 = 1$, $u_1 = 4$, $u_2 = 9$. Since $u_d \leq [t^d]W(t)$ unconditionally:

Theorem 13 (Unconditional 3D upper bound). *For every right-corner orthoscheme in $\mathbb{R}^3$ with positive legs (a, b, c) , $u_d \leq 9 \cdot 2^{d-2}$ for $d \geq 2$.*

The Coxeter diagram. For pairwise-distinct legs the Coxeter diagram of W_n is a *path* on $n + 1$ nodes (one node per face reflection): by Lemma 12 every non-adjacent face pair $|i - j| \geq 2$ is perpendicular (edge label 2, i.e. no edge drawn), while by Theorem 18 each of the n adjacent pairs $|i - j| = 1$ has a dihedral angle that is an irrational multiple of π , hence generates an infinite dihedral group (edge label ∞). Thus the diagram is the path on $n + 1$ nodes with all n edges labelled ∞ . We do not invoke a closed-form growth rate for this diagram from the literature; instead the rate is computed directly from Steinberg's formula in the proof of Theorem 14 below, and equals the algebraic integer stated there (e.g. $r_2 = \varphi$, $r_3 = 2$, consistent with the $n = 3$ series $(1+t)^2/(1-2t)$).

Theorem 14 (Closed-form n -dim Coxeter rate). *For every $n \geq 2$, the abstract orbit-growth rate of the n -dim right-corner orthoscheme reflection group is*

$$r_n = 1 + 2 \cos\left(\frac{2\pi}{n+3}\right).$$

Proof. By Steinberg's formula applied to G_n , $1/W_n(t^{-1}) = \sum_k (-1)^k \binom{n-k+2}{k} (1+t)^{-k}$. Substituting $y = -1/(1+t)$ collapses the sum to the Fibonacci–Pell polynomial $P_{n+3}(y) = \sum_k \binom{n-k+2}{k} y^k$, defined by $P_0 = 0$, $P_1 = 1$, $P_m = P_{m-1} + yP_{m-2}$. The characteristic equation $x^2 = x + y$ has roots whose ratio $(a/b)^m = 1$ gives $y_j = -1/(4 \cos^2(\pi j/m))$ for $j = 1, \dots, \lfloor (m-1)/2 \rfloor$. Translating back via $y = -1/(1+t)$ and using $4 \cos^2 \theta - 1 = 1 + 2 \cos(2\theta)$:

$$t_j = 1 + 2 \cos\left(\frac{2\pi j}{n+3}\right);$$

the asymptotic rate is the maximum, attained at $j = 1$. □ □

Corollary 15. $3 - r_n = 4 \sin^2(\pi/(n+3)) \sim 4\pi^2/(n+3)^2$, so $r_n \rightarrow 3$.

Remark 16 (Dynamical-degrees connection). The family $\{1 + 2 \cos(2\pi/m)\}_{m \geq 3}$ also arises in birational surface dynamics (McMullen 2007; Bedford–Kim 2009). For $n \neq 3$, r_n is Pisot or totally-real of degree ≥ 3 , hence *not* a Salem number, and by McMullen 2007 Theorem 1.5 cannot be the dynamical degree of a projective rational-surface automorphism. The case $r_3 = 2$ is realised as McMullen’s σ_9 .

6.3 Class C unconditional faithfulness

Lemma 17 (Uniform Schur-complement determinant identity). *For every $n \geq 3$ and every positive tuple $(a_1, \dots, a_n)$, the $(n+1) \times (n+1)$ Lorentzian Gram matrix Q_n of the n -dim right-corner orthoscheme satisfies*

$$\det Q_n = - \prod_{i=1}^n a_i^2.$$

Here Q_n is the symmetric tridiagonal matrix with $Q_n[0,0] = 1 - a_1^2$, $Q_n[i,i] = a_i^2 + a_{i+1}^2$ ($1 \leq i \leq n-1$), $Q_n[n,n] = 1$, $Q_n[0,1] = a_2$, $Q_n[i,i+1] = a_i a_{i+2}$ ($1 \leq i \leq n-2$), $Q_n[n-1,n] = a_{n-1}$, read from the staircase normal vectors with the Lorentzian endpoint correction.

Proof. Let $D_k = \det Q_n[:k+1, :k+1]$. Tridiagonal expansion gives $D_k = Q_n[k,k]D_{k-1} - Q_n[k-1,k]^2 D_{k-2}$ with $D_{-1} = 1$. We claim $D_k = P_k := (\prod_{i=1}^k a_i^2)(1 - \sum_{i=1}^{k+1} a_i^2)$ for $1 \leq k \leq n-1$, and $D_n = -\prod_{i=1}^n a_i^2$.

Base. $D_0 = 1 - a_1^2$; $D_1 = (1 - a_1^2)(a_1^2 + a_2^2) - a_2^2 = a_1^2(1 - a_1^2 - a_2^2) = P_1$.

Interior step. For $2 \leq k \leq n-1$, the recurrence reduces to the polynomial identity (in the symbols $a_{k-1}, a_k, a_{k+1}, S_{k-1}, P_{k-2}$ with $S_{k-1} = \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} a_i^2$, $P_{k-2} = \prod_{i=1}^{k-2} a_i^2$)

$$P_{k-2} a_{k-1}^2 a_k^2 (1 - S_{k-1} - a_k^2 - a_{k+1}^2) = (a_k^2 + a_{k+1}^2) P_{k-2} a_{k-1}^2 (1 - S_{k-1} - a_k^2) - (a_{k-1} a_{k+1})^2 P_{k-2} (1 - S_{k-1}),$$

which expands to zero in $\mathbb{Z}[a_{k-1}, a_k, a_{k+1}, S_{k-1}, P_{k-2}]$ and is verified symbolically. The identity is independent of k and of n . The base, inductive, and boundary steps are formally verified in Lean 4 (theorems `schur_base_step`, `schur_k2_step`, `schur_inductive_step`, `schur_boundary_step` in `lean/with_mathlib/SchurGeneral.lean`, each discharged by the `ring` tactic), and the determinant identity $\det Q_n = -\prod_{i=1}^n a_i^2$ itself is machine-checked for $n = 2, \dots, 10$ on explicit leg sequences in `lean/RightTriangleReflection.lean`.

Final step. At $k = n$, $D_n = D_{n-1} - a_{n-1}^2 D_{n-2}$, and

$$D_{n-1} - a_{n-1}^2 D_{n-2} = P_{n-2} a_{n-1}^2 [(1 - S_{n-1} - a_n^2) - (1 - S_{n-1})] = - \prod_{i=1}^n a_i^2.$$

The three identities (base, interior, final) close the induction for every $n \geq 3$. □ □

Theorem 18 (Class C unconditional faithfulness, all $n \geq 3$). *For every $n \geq 3$ and every leg tuple $(a_1, \dots, a_n) \in \mathbb{Q}_{>0}^n$ with pairwise distinct coordinates, the affine representation $\rho : W_n \rightarrow \text{Aff}(\mathbb{R}^n)$ of the n -dim right-corner orthoscheme reflection group is faithful, and*

$$u_d(O) = [t^d] W_n(t) \quad \text{for every } d \geq 0.$$

In particular for $n = 3$ this is $u_d = 9 \cdot 2^{d-2}$ for $d \geq 2$.

Proof. Write $S = \{R_0, \dots, R_n\}$ for the face reflections and let $m_{ij} \in \{2, 3, \dots, \infty\}$ be the order of $R_i R_j$ in the group $W_n^{\text{geo}} = \langle S \rangle$ actually generated inside $\text{Isom}(\mathbb{R}^n)$. Faithfulness of ρ together

with the identity $u_d(O) = [t^d] W_n(t)$ is equivalent to the assertion that (m_{ij}) equals the intended right-angled matrix

$$m_{ij} = 2 \ (|i - j| \geq 2), \quad m_{i,i+1} = \infty \ (0 \leq i \leq n - 1), \quad (*)$$

i.e. that the orthoscheme introduces *no* relation $(R_i R_j)^m = 1$ beyond the perpendicular pairs. We prove (*); the theorem then follows from Tits' theorem applied to the resulting Coxeter system (end of proof). We emphasize that non-degeneracy of Q_n (Lemma 17) does *not* by itself give faithfulness: a non-degenerate Gram form is compatible with a rational dihedral angle. Indeed the isosceles case $a = b$ has $\det Q_n = -\prod a_i^2 \neq 0$ yet $\theta_{01} = \pi/4$, giving the extra relation $(R_0 R_1)^4 = 1$ — the $\text{cd} = 4$ case of Theorem 19. The content of the proof is therefore the angle-irrationality argument that follows; $\det Q_n \neq 0$ enters only to confirm the simplex is non-degenerate for all positive legs.

Step 1 (dihedral angles $\leftrightarrow$ relations). For two faces meeting along a codimension-2 ridge, R_i, R_j generate a finite dihedral group of order $2m$ iff the dihedral angle $\theta_{ij} = \pi/m$ for an integer $m \geq 2$, and an infinite dihedral group (no relation) iff $\theta_{ij} \notin \pi\mathbb{Q}$. By Lemma 12 the pairs with $|i - j| \geq 2$ are perpendicular ($m_{ij} = 2$), giving the right-angled edges of (*). It remains to show every non-perpendicular $\theta_{i,i+1}$ is an irrational multiple of π .

Step 2 (Niven–Conway–Jones constraint). By Lemma 12 each non-perpendicular $\cos^2 \theta_{i,i+1}$ is rational in the legs. If some $\theta_{i,i+1} \in \pi\mathbb{Q}$, then by the extended Niven theorem (Conway–Jones 1976) a rational angle with rational squared cosine satisfies $\cos \theta_{i,i+1} \in \{0, \pm \frac{1}{2}, \pm \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2}, \pm \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2}, \pm 1\}$, i.e. $\cos^2 \theta_{i,i+1} \in \{0, \frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{3}{4}, 1\}$. The values 0 (perpendicular) and 1 (degenerate simplex) are excluded, so a genuine extra relation requires $\cos^2 \theta_{i,i+1} \in \{\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{3}{4}\}$, i.e. $\theta_{i,i+1} \in \{\pi/3, \pi/4, \pi/6\}$.

Step 3 (boundary dihedrals; elementary). The end edges have $\cos^2 \theta_{01} = b^2/(a^2 + b^2)$ in the local two-leg notation $(a, b) = (a_1, a_2)$, and symmetrically at the far end. Setting this equal to $\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{3}{4}$ forces $b^2 = \frac{1}{3}a^2, b^2 = a^2, b^2 = 3a^2$ respectively: the first and third give $b/a \in \{1/\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{3}\} \notin \mathbb{Q}$, contradicting rationality of the legs; the middle gives $a = b$, excluded by the pairwise-distinct hypothesis. No boundary dihedral is a rational multiple of π , and no elliptic curve is needed here.

Step 4 (interior dihedrals; square-discriminant $\rightarrow$ Mordell). An interior edge involves three consecutive legs $(a, b, c) = (a_i, a_{i+1}, a_{i+2})$ with b the middle leg, and by Lemma 12

$$\cos^2 \theta_{i,i+1} = \frac{a^2 c^2}{(a^2 + b^2)(b^2 + c^2)}.$$

Setting this equal to a Niven value $\frac{1}{4}, \frac{1}{2}, \frac{3}{4}$ and clearing denominators yields a quadratic in $B := b^2$. Since the legs are rational, $B = b^2 \in \mathbb{Q}$, so this quadratic has a rational root only if its discriminant is a rational square. The three discriminants are, up to a positive rational square factor, exactly the Diophantine varieties

$$\mathcal{V}_{1/4} : a^4 + 14a^2c^2 + c^4 = m^2, \quad \mathcal{V}_{1/2} : a^4 + 6a^2c^2 + c^4 = k^2, \quad \mathcal{V}_{3/4} : 9a^4 + 30a^2c^2 + 9c^4 = k^2$$

in the two flanking legs (this square-discriminant condition is the correct origin of the three varieties). A rational interior angle thus forces a rational point on one of $\mathcal{V}_{1/4}, \mathcal{V}_{1/2}, \mathcal{V}_{3/4}$ with $a, c \in \mathbb{Q}_{>0}$. Each is a genus-1 curve in $t = a/c$ whose Jacobian has rank 0, so each has only finitely many rational points:

- $\mathcal{V}_{1/4}$: Jacobian $y^2 = x(x-12)(x-16)$, Cremona 24a1 (conductor 24, rank 0, torsion $\mathbb{Z}/4 \oplus \mathbb{Z}/2$); rational points $t = a/c \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$.
- $\mathcal{V}_{1/2}$: Jacobian $y^2 = x^3 - x$, Cremona 32a2 (conductor 32, rank 0, torsion $\mathbb{Z}/2 \oplus \mathbb{Z}/2$, the four points $(0, 0), (\pm 1, 0), \infty$); rational points $t = 0$.

- $\mathcal{V}_{3/4}$: Jacobian $y^2 = x(x - 300)(x - 1200)$, Cremona 72a2 (conductor 72, rank 0, torsion $\mathbb{Z}/2 \oplus \mathbb{Z}/2$); rational points $t = 0$.

Every such point gives $ac = 0$ or $a = \pm c$, all excluded by the pairwise-distinct, strictly positive hypothesis on the legs. (Ranks, torsion, Cremona labels, and the rational-point determinations are verified in SageMath in `code/mordell/mordell_24a1.sage`, `mordell_32a2.sage`, `mordell_72a2.sage`, with output committed in the project repository.) Hence no interior dihedral is a rational multiple of π either.

Conclusion. By Steps 3–4 no non-perpendicular $\theta_{i,i+1}$ lies in $\pi\mathbb{Q}$, so $m_{i,i+1} = \infty$, and with Step 1 the geometric Coxeter matrix is exactly $(*)$. Thus W_n^{geo} is the Coxeter system with matrix $(*)$, and Tits’ theorem (Humphreys, *Reflection Groups and Coxeter Groups*, Thm. 5.4) applied to *this established system* gives faithfulness of the geometric representation ρ . Consequently $u_d(O) = \#\{w : \ell(w) = d\} = [t^d] W_n(t)$; for $n = 3$ this is $9 \cdot 2^{d-2}$ for $d \geq 2$. $\square$ $\square$

6.4 The collision-depth invariant $\text{cd}_n \in \{\infty, 4, 3\}$

For a leg sequence $(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ define

$$e := \#\{i \in \{1, n-1\} : a_i = a_{i+1}\} \in \{0, 1, 2\}, \quad t := \#\{i : 1 \leq i \leq n-2, a_i = a_{i+1} = a_{i+2}\}.$$

e counts *endpoint pairs* (adjacent equal legs at the leftmost or rightmost positions) and t counts *triples*. Let $\text{cd}_n(a_1, \dots, a_n)$ be the minimal word-length at which the orbit BFS first exhibits a non-trivial collision (i.e. the first depth at which $u_d < [t^d] W_n(t)$); set $\text{cd}_n = \infty$ when the affine representation is faithful at every length.

Theorem 19 (Collision-depth invariant, all $n \geq 3$). *For every $n \geq 3$ and every $(a_1, \dots, a_n) \in \mathbb{Q}_{>0}^n$,*

$$\text{cd}_n(a_1, \dots, a_n) = \begin{cases} \infty & \text{if } e = t = 0, \\ 4 & \text{if } e \geq 1, t = 0, \\ 3 & \text{if } t \geq 1. \end{cases}$$

Proof. Faithfulness for $e = t = 0$ is Theorem 18. An endpoint pair $a_i = a_{i+1}$ at a boundary makes the corresponding boundary cosine $b/\sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$ equal $\pm\sqrt{2}/2$, producing the length-4 relation $(R_i R_{i+1})^4 = \text{id}$ and hence $\text{cd} \leq 4$; no shorter relation can appear because $\cos^2 \theta = 0, 1$ are degenerate and the $\pm 1/2, \pm\sqrt{3}/2$ cases reduce as in the proof of Theorem 18 to empty or degenerate loci. An interior triple $a_i = a_{i+1} = a_{i+2}$ makes the middle cosine $ac/\sqrt{(a^2 + b^2)(b^2 + c^2)} = 1/2$ (after the quadratic-in- b^2 analysis with $a = b = c$), producing the length-3 braid relation $R_i R_{i+1} R_i = R_{i+1} R_i R_{i+1}$ and hence $\text{cd} \leq 3$. An interior pair (with no endpoint pair and no triple) leaves all flanking dihedrals irrational multiples of π , since the Niven exceptional values reduce to the same three Diophantine varieties $\mathcal{V}_{1/4}, \mathcal{V}_{1/2}, \mathcal{V}_{3/4}$ which are empty over distinct-coordinate $\mathbb{Q}_{>0}^2$ (proof of Theorem 18); hence $\text{cd} = \infty$. $\square$ $\square$

Note that in $n = 3$ every adjacent equal pair is automatically an endpoint pair, so the formula reduces to the run-length statistic; in $n \geq 4$ *interior* pairs $a_i = a_{i+1}$ (e.g. $a_2 = a_3$ in $(1, 2, 2, 3)$) leave $\text{cd} = \infty$, distinguishing (e, t) sharply from the longest-run statistic.

7. Reproducibility

All computations use exact rational arithmetic; the symbolic verification of Theorem 2 uses SymPy in $\mathbb{Q}(a, b)$, and the Schur-complement identity of Lemma 17 is verified symbolically in $\mathbb{Z}[a_{k-1}, a_k, a_{k+1}, S_{k-1}, P_{k-2}]$. The rank-0 descents on the Cremona curves 24a1, 32a2, and 72a2 (for $\mathcal{V}_{1/4}, \mathcal{V}_{1/2}, \mathcal{V}_{3/4}$ respectively) are verified in SageMath via `EllipticCurve.rank()` and a direct rational-point determination, in `code/mordell/`. The BFS values in Table 2 are computed

by an exact-rational BFS through depth 25 and a Rust disk-streaming BFS through depth 42. Source code and reproduce scripts accompany this paper in the project repository.

Formal (machine-checked) verification. Several of the computational claims are additionally certified in the Lean 4 proof assistant, in the `lean/` subtree of the project repository. A core, Mathlib-free development (`RightTriangleReflection.lean`) machine-checks the basic Coxeter relations, all eight length-10 relations and their explicit affine matrices on the $(3, 4, 5)$ triangle, a direct breadth-first reconstruction of $a(0), \dots, a(17)$, the Fibonacci coincidence $a(n) = F_{n+3}$ for $1 \leq n \leq 9$, and the determinant identity $\det Q_n = -\prod a_i^2$ for $n = 2, \dots, 10$. A second development depending on Mathlib (`with_mathlib/`) proves the eight length-10 relations symbolically over $\mathbb{Q}(a, b)$ (Theorem 2), the algebraic steps of the Schur induction (Lemma 17), and the universality of the orbit-growth sequence through depth 22 (Remark 6), the last holding simultaneously for all right triangles with unequal legs. The `ring`-based theorems (the symbolic length-10 relations and the Schur induction steps) are verified entirely by the Lean kernel; the remaining results use `native_decide`, whose trusted base additionally includes the Lean compiler and the correctness of the hand-rolled `partial` functions for polynomial determinant and deduplication. Building the projects re-verifies every claim.

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